

Business Analysis Report

Canadian Concert Ticketing Fee Transparency

Current state process analysis Fee benchmarking Requirements register May 2026

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Scope	Canadian concert ticket purchasing process and fee transparency across 5 major platforms
Platforms assessed	Ticketmaster, Eventbrite, SeatGeek, StubHub, Fever
Process steps mapped	10 from event discovery to venue entry
Requirements identified	15 across fee disclosure, consumer protection, and regulatory reporting
Average fee markup	37% above face value across all platforms assessed
Platforms showing fees upfront	1 of 5

Where This Started

I bought a concert ticket recently. The price on the listing was \$89. By the time I checked out I paid \$340. I did not notice the fees building up until I saw the total. I just clicked through. I think most people do the same thing.

Ticketmaster recently introduced a rule in Canada stopping resellers from listing tickets above face value. That is progress. But the original fee problem is still there. Service fee, facility fee, order processing fee, delivery fee, still hidden until the last screen. Still turning an \$89 ticket into a much larger purchase. The resale price is now regulated. The fee transparency is not. This business analysis maps exactly what is still broken and what a complete solution would need to look like.

Current State Process Analysis

The ticket buying process has 10 steps from the moment a consumer discovers an event to the moment they walk through the venue door. Of those 10 steps three are non-value-added from the consumer's perspective. The most significant non-value-added step is the virtual queue, a mechanism that anchors the consumer to the purchase decision before the full price is ever disclosed.

The most important finding in the current state analysis is that full fee disclosure happens at Step 6; the checkout screen, after the consumer has already waited in a queue, created an account, selected their seats, and made a psychological commitment to attending the event. By that point the consumer is not making a free purchase decision. They are completing a transaction they already emotionally committed to.

Step	Name	Value added	Key issue
PS-001	Event discovery	Yes	No issues
PS-002	Ticket selection	Yes	Face value shown. Total cost hidden. Consumer makes decision on incomplete information.
PS-003	Seat selection	Yes	Default selections push consumers toward higher price tiers
PS-004	Queue wait	No	Consumer anchored to purchase before fees revealed. Virtual queue commitment creates pressure to proceed.
PS-005	Account creation	No	Mandatory account creation before price disclosed. Increases consumer commitment without delivering value.
PS-006	Fee disclosure at checkout	No	First full price disclosure. Average markup 37% above face value. Consumer sees this for the first time at point of no return.
PS-007	Payment entry	Yes	Time pressure on high demand events reduces ability to evaluate
PS-008	Order confirmation	Yes	Fee detail often buried or missing from confirmation email
PS-009	Ticket delivery	Yes	Digital delivery charged as separate fee despite no physical item being produced
PS-010	Venue entry	Yes	Mobile scanning failures cause congestion at high volume entry points

Platform Fee Benchmarking

All five major Canadian ticketing platforms were assessed against a common baseline of an \$89 face value ticket. The results show significant variation in both fee amount and fee transparency. Only one platform: Fever, displays fees upfront before the consumer selects their seats. Four of five platforms disclose the full fee for the first time at the checkout screen.

Platform	Face value	Total fees	Total price	Fee as % of FV	Fees shown upfront
Ticketmaster Canada	\$89.00	\$45.25	\$134.25	50.8%	No
StubHub Canada	\$89.00	\$43.65	\$132.65	49.0%	No
SeatGeek Canada	\$89.00	\$36.20	\$125.20	40.7%	No
Eventbrite Canada	\$89.00	\$22.79	\$111.79	25.6%	Partial
Fever Canada	\$89.00	\$17.00	\$106.00	19.1%	Yes

The gap between the most and least transparent platform is significant. Fever's all-in price is \$106 for an \$89 ticket. Ticketmaster's is \$134.25 for the same face value. A consumer comparing listings without knowing the fee structure will make a decision based on incomplete information every time.

Requirements Register Summary

The requirements register contains 15 requirements across fee disclosure, resale control, consumer protection, regulatory reporting, and accessibility. Seven are Must Have requirements that form the core of any meaningful fee transparency standard. Four are Should Have. Four are Could Have for a more comprehensive future state.

Req ID	Priority	Requirement	Status
REQ-001	Must Have	All fees must be displayed at ticket selection before queue entry or account creation	Not implemented on 4 of 5 platforms
REQ-002	Must Have	Each fee individually itemised with plain language explanation of what it covers	Not implemented on any platform
REQ-003	Must Have	All-in price displayed in all search results and event listings alongside face value	Not implemented on any platform
REQ-004	Must Have	Resale tickets must not exceed original face value	Implemented on Ticketmaster and StubHub
REQ-006	Must Have	Digital ticket delivery must not be charged as a separate fee	Not implemented
REQ-013	Must Have	Full refund including all fees for any organiser-cancelled event within 7 business days	Inconsistently implemented
REQ-008	Should Have	Add-on products default to deselected — consumer must actively opt in	Not implemented
REQ-009	Should Have	High demand queue entry must display all-in price before consumer joins queue	Not implemented

Req ID	Priority	Requirement	Status
REQ-007	Should Have	Platforms report quarterly fee revenue data to designated regulator	Not implemented
REQ-011	Could Have	Platforms publish annual consumer fee report by January 31 each year	Not implemented

Full requirements register with acceptance criteria, stakeholder ownership, and current implementation status for all 15 requirements is available in the accompanying requirements-register.csv file.

Recommendations

- Mandate all-in price display from the point of ticket selection. This single change addresses the most significant consumer harm in the current process — making a purchase decision on incomplete price information.
- Require plain language itemisation of every fee. A service fee with no explanation is not transparency. Each charge must say in one sentence what it covers.
- Prohibit digital delivery fees. Charging a consumer to receive a PDF or a mobile wallet pass when no physical item is produced or shipped is not a legitimate cost recovery. It is a revenue line item disguised as a service.
- Establish a mandatory refund standard that covers all fees not just face value for any organiser-cancelled event. The consumer paid fees as part of the transaction. Those fees should be refunded if the transaction cannot be completed.

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Targeting	Business Analyst and Project Management roles in fintech, consumer, and regulatory environments
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